Uttar Pradesh CA

> **Priority S for UPPCS** National magazines often under-count UP. In the real paper, UP news comes through Ramsar, Budget, ODOP, ranks, and big projects. **Subject notes home:** UP Special Topic 8 — Schemes & Miscellaneous · full map UP Special

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Which district or city?	Etah, Lucknow, Varanasi, Noida…
Any rank or category?	SDG, Swachh, FDI, agri
Any scheme or project name?	Exact title
Any wildlife or Ramsar site?	Site + district
Any “first in UP” claim?	Confirm carefully

High-Yield UP Foundation Matrix (Late 2025)

> **UPPCS Pattern Alert:** Late-year announcements frequently appear in the prelims paper. Memorise these district connections and milestones:

Event / Project	District / Location	Key Prelims Fact
UNESCO Creative City of Gastronomy	**Lucknow**	Conferred in **October 2025**; joins UNESCO Creative Cities Network (UCCN).
India’s 1st Swastik-shaped ‘Lotus Garden’	**CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow**	Inaugurated **15 Sept 2025** by Dr. Jitendra Singh & CM Yogi Adityanath; Area: **930 sq. metres**.
Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2025	**Agra, Jhansi, Moradabad**	**Agra:** Joint 3rd (>10L category, 196/200); **Jhansi & Moradabad:** Joint 2nd (3–10L category, 198.5/200).
Ayodhya Deepotsav 2025	**Ayodhya (Saryu River)**	**9th edition** (19 Oct 2025); Guinness World Record of **26,17,215** oil lamps (diyas).
Indigenous Hydrogen Vessel	**Varanasi**	Commercial operations of India’s first fully indigenous hydrogen fuel cell passenger vessel began **11 Dec 2025**.
4th Kashi Tamil Sangamam	**Varanasi**	Cultural integration initiative celebrated in Varanasi (late 2025).
Basmati & Organic Training Centre	**Pilibhit**	India’s first integrated Basmati & Organic Training Centre-cum-Demonstration Farm.
Air Quality Alert (CREA Report)	**Ghaziabad**	Ranked as the **most polluted city in India** in November 2025.
Cultural Legend Obituary	**Varanasi**	**Pt. Chhannulal Mishra** passed away (2 Oct 2025 at 89); Kirana & Benaras gharana; Padma Vibhushan (2020), Yash Bharti; PM Modi’s Varanasi proposer in 2014.
Axiom Mission 4 (Ax-4) Pilot	**Lucknow**	Group Captain **Shubhanshu Shukla** (born in **Lucknow**) served as Pilot of SpaceX Crew Dragon ‘Grace’ to the ISS; **1st Indian astronaut on the ISS**, 2nd Indian in orbit after Rakesh Sharma (1984).
Supercomputer ‘Arunika’ (Global Rank #251)	**NCMRWF, Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar)**	NCMRWF’s high-performance weather forecasting supercomputer ranked **#251 globally** in the TOP 500 Supercomputers list (Nov 2025, 5.94 PFlop/s Rmax); 3rd fastest supercomputer in India.
Sambhav Campaign 6.0 (संभव अभियान 6.0)	**All 75 Districts of UP**	Flagship nutrition drive (July–Sept 2026); Core theme: *“गर्भावस्था से बाल्यावस्था तक पोषण सुरक्षा”* (Nutritional Security from Pregnancy to Childhood).

Sambhav Campaign 6.0 (संभव अभियान 6.0) | July–September 2026 | All 75 Districts

What happened The Government of Uttar Pradesh launched the 6th edition of its flagship statewide nutrition campaign, **Sambhav Abhiyan 6.0**, across all 75 districts under the Department of Women & Child Development (ICDS) in convergence with the Health and Panchayati Raj departments and UNICEF.

Core facts & Prelims Traps - **Core Theme:** *"गर्भावस्था से बाल्यावस्था तक पोषण सुरक्षा"* (**Nutritional Security from Pregnancy to Early Childhood**). - **Core Focus Area:** Adopts a 'Life-Cycle Approach' concentrating on the critical **First 1,000 Days** of child life (from conception up to 2 years of age). - **Key Interventions:** - Identification and digital tracking of **SAM (Severely Acute Malnourished)** and **MAM (Moderately Acute Malnourished)** children on the state's **e-Kavach** digital portal. - Dedicated home visits by Anganwadi workers and ANMs for counselling on complementary feeding, Take Home Ration (THR) recipes, and immunization. - Convergence monitoring at district level via District Nutrition Committees headed by District Magistrates.

Jal Pakhwada in UP schools | 16–30 April 2026

What happened Uttar Pradesh ran a **Jal Pakhwada** (water fortnight) in **all schools and educational institutions** under the **Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain** push.

Core facts

- Dates: **16 April to 30 April 2026**.
- Aim: make water conservation a student-led mass movement (daily water pledge, clean drinking-water sources, competitions, rallies).
- Schools report activities online; coordination with Jal Nigam, Panchayati Raj, Basic Education, and Health.

> **Trap**

Do not pick Mission Amrit Sarovar, Atal Bhujal, or Namami Gange when the stem is the **April 2026 school water fortnight**. The name is **Jal Pakhwada**.

Nand Baba Milk Mission — scheme family

What it is UP's dairy push (about **₹1,000 crore** framing) to expand milk cooperatives and indigenous cattle units.

Schemes under the Mission (remember these three)

1. **Mukhyamantri Swadeshi Gau-Samvardhan Yojana**
2. **Mukhyamantri Pragatisheel Pashupalak Protsahan Yojana**
3. **Nandini Krishak Samriddhi Yojana** (plus Mini Nandini)

> **Trap**

Kamdhenu Dairy Yojana is **not** listed as a current Nand Baba Mission component in the official scheme set. Older Kamdhenu beneficiaries are often **ineligible** for the new Nandini units.

Chuka Beach | Pilibhit Tiger Reserve

What happened / what it is Chuka Beach is an eco-tourism riverside beach on the **Sharda / Sharda Sagar** side inside **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** (not Dudhwa).

Core facts

- District: **Pilibhit**, Terai UP.
- Stay options: Tharu / bamboo / tree huts; visit usually via reserve safari booking.
- Trap: stems often park Chuka under **Dudhwa**. Correct reserve = **Pilibhit**.

MV Ganga Vilas | flagged off 13 January 2023 | Varanasi

What happened PM Modi flagged off **MV Ganga Vilas**, billed as the world's longest river cruise, from **Varanasi**.

Core facts

- Route memory: **Varanasi** → **Dibrugarh (Assam)** via Bangladesh; about **3,200 km** / **~51 days**; ~**27** river systems.
- Vessel: three decks, **18** suites, capacity about **36** tourists; Make-in-India cruise.

Karikot village | Bahraich | ICRT Award 2025

What happened Karikot (Bahraich, UP) received the **International Subcontinent Responsible Tourism (ICRT) Award 2025**.

Core facts

- Category to remember: **Climate Adaptation and Resilience** (not waste / local sourcing / peace-inclusion distractors).
- District: **Bahraich**.

January 2026

Patna Bird Sanctuary, Etah — Ramsar site

What happened Patna Bird Sanctuary in **Etah** district got strong national attention as a **Ramsar site** (wetland of international importance). It was announced together with Gujarat's Chhari-Dhand.

Core facts

- Site: **Patna Bird Sanctuary**.
- District: **Etah**, Uttar Pradesh.
- Size: among the smallest UP bird sanctuaries; about **1 sq km** / around **108 hectares**.
- It is a key winter home for migratory birds.

Related UP wetlands (do not mix announcement months)

Site	District	When to revise
Shekha / Sheikha Jheel	**Aligarh**	Public Ramsar push locked in **April** (India 99 / UP 12)
Surha Tal / JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary	**Ballia**	Big WED announcement in **June** (India 100 / UP 13)

Some lists show early-2026 designation paperwork. For prelims, fact the **month the news broke** in the table above. Full chain → Master tables.

Padma Awards — UP names

- **Padma Vibhushan: N Rajam** (Art), Uttar Pradesh.
- Several Padma Shri names from UP were also announced. The full list is under Awards.

UP Statehood Day (24 January 2026) — New Schemes

What happened UP Statehood Day was celebrated at **Rashtra Prerna Sthal, Lucknow**. Union Home and Cooperation Minister **Amit Shah** attended as chief guest alongside CM Yogi Adityanath.

Core schemes launched - **'One District, One Cuisine' (ODOC) Scheme:** Launched on the lines of ODOP to promote traditional and local culinary heritage of each district. - **Sardar Patel Industrial Area Scheme:** Inaugurated to accelerate balanced industrial infrastructure across districts.

Lucknow — India's First "Zero Fresh Waste Dump City" (21 January 2026)

- **Lucknow** became the **first city in Uttar Pradesh** to attain the milestone of **"Zero Fresh Waste Dump City"**, processing 100% of its daily generated municipal solid waste without sending fresh unsegregated waste to legacy landfills.

UP Governor's Residence Renamed "Jan Bhavan" (17 January 2026)

- The official residence of the Governor of Uttar Pradesh in Lucknow (formerly **Raj Bhavan**) has been officially renamed as ***"Jan Bhavan"***.

86th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC)

- **Dates & Venue: 19–21 January 2026** at the **Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Sabha, Lucknow**.
- **Inauguration:** Addressed by Lok Sabha Speaker **Om Birla**.

Republic Day Parade 2026 — UP Tableau

- **Uttar Pradesh Tableau Theme: *"Culture of Bundelkhand"*** (showcasing historical heritage, local arts, and folk culture of the Bundelkhand region).
- *(Note: Ministry of Culture Tableau theme was "150 Years of Vande Mataram").*

February 2026

Uttar Pradesh Budget 2026–27

What happened State Finance Minister **Suresh Khanna** presented the UP Budget for **2026–27**.

Core facts

- Budget size: about **₹9.13 lakh crore** (detailed figure near **₹9,12,696 crore**).
- Rise over previous year: about **12.2%**.
- Capital expenditure share: about **19.5%**.
- Fiscal deficit target: **3%**, in line with **16th Finance Commission** guidance up to **2030–31**.

Uttar Pradesh Economic Review 2025–26 (Presented 9 February 2026)

- **UP GSDP Growth Trajectory:**
- GSDP in 2016–17: **~₹13.30 lakh crore**.
- GSDP Quick Estimates for 2024–25: **~₹30.25 lakh crore** (more than doubled).

Selected spending ideas

- Convert primary schools into **Smart Schools** under Samagra Shiksha.
- About **₹580 crore** for girls' schools in blocks that do not have Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas.
- About **₹3,500 crore** under the Chief Minister's **Urban Expansion and New City Promotion Scheme**.
- Health: money for new medical colleges through PPP, plus specialty care lines such as the Cancer Institute in Lucknow in Budget highlights.

How the Union Budget touches UP

- UP's combined central share was described as near **₹4.26 lakh crore**, up by about **₹34,000 crore**.
- Tax devolution to UP was described as rising to about **₹2.68 lakh crore**.
- Place-linked Budget ideas: ship repair at **Varanasi**; heritage work at **Sarnath** and **Hastinapur**; high-speed rail connectivity stories around Varanasi; support ideas linked to ODOP and Gram Swaraj.

Other February UP current affairs

CCSU Meerut AI pilot

- **Chaudhary Charan Singh University, Meerut** was named a national pilot for an AI-enabled university.
- Partners named in reports: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, Google Cloud, and Placecom.

UP Pharma Conclave 1.0, Lucknow

- The state pitched pharma and medical-device investment.
- MoUs of about **₹10,000 crore** were reported.
- Existing pitch points include the Bulk Drug Pharma Park in **Lalitpur** and a Medical Device Park near the Yamuna Expressway.

Sarus crane census

- The sarus crane is the **state bird** of Uttar Pradesh.
- Latest winter count reported: about **20,628** birds.
- Earlier points in the same series: about **19,994**, and about **19,196** in 2023.
- Highest counts were reported from **Etawah** and **Mainpuri** forest divisions.

Other short facts

- Semiconductor unit narrative in **Greater Noida (Gautam Buddh Nagar)** as North India's first — confirm status before using "commissioned".

- Farmer helpline from Lucknow: **0522-2317003**, Monday to Friday, for scheme information.
- Magh Mela 2026 management may appear as a soft culture question.

March 2026

Keep revising older UP facts

March's biggest national stories were the T20 World Cup, defence purchases, NavIC, Gujarat UCC, and central schemes. For UPPCS, keep January–February UP cards ready:

- Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah) Ramsar
- Padma names, especially **N Rajam**
- State Budget about **₹9.13 lakh crore**
- CCSU Meerut AI pilot
- Sarus crane census

Laxman Award & Rani Lakshmibai Award Hike | 24 March 2026

What happened The Uttar Pradesh Government announced a substantial increase in the prize money for the state's highest sports honours: the **Laxman Award** (for male sportspersons) and the **Rani Lakshmibai Award** (for female sportspersons).

Core facts - **Previous Prize Money:** ₹3.11 lakh each. - **Revised Prize Money: ₹10 lakh each** (along with a bronze statue and citation).

Soft follow-ups for later months

- Fresh Ramsar count after Sheikha Jheel / Surha Tal
- Jewar airport or expressway headlines with clear dates
- Padma conferment ceremony dates for UP awardees (announcement was in January)

April 2026

Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary | Aligarh | Ramsar site

What happened Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary in **Aligarh** got the Ramsar tag in April 2026. This is a high-yield UPPCS fact.

Core facts

- District: **Aligarh**.
- India's Ramsar total after this: **99**.
- Uttar Pradesh's Ramsar total after this: **12**.
- Flyway: **Central Asian Flyway**.
- Full ecology card → Environment.

> **Confused pair**

Patna Bird Sanctuary is in **Etah** (January). Shekha Jheel is in **Aligarh** (April). Surha Tal / Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary in **Ballia** became the **100th** later — keep that for June revision.

Noida International Airport (Jewar)

What happened April coverage said commercial flights from **Jewar Airport** were targeted to start on **30 May 2026**, with ticket booking expected around mid-May. Security-clearance issues around the CEO's nationality were discussed in the delay story.

Court fact

- On **28 April 2026**, the Allahabad High Court upheld land acquisition of about **1,858 hectares** for Jewar airport expansion (Phase-2 / Phase-3 related villages in **Gautam Buddha Nagar**).
- The court stressed timely rehabilitation and resettlement under the **2013** land acquisition law.

Northern Region Agriculture Conference (24 April 2026)

- **Venue: Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh**.
- **Organiser:** Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare.
- **Focus:** Enhancing farm productivity, crop diversification, and organic/natural farming adoption in northern states.

Ganga Expressway Inauguration | 29 April 2026

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **594-kilometre-long** greenfield **Ganga Expressway** at a mega-ceremony held in **Hardoi, Uttar Pradesh**.

Core specs & prelims facts - **Length: 594 km** (access-controlled, 6-lane expandable to 8 lanes). - **Starting Point: Bijauli village** in **Meerut** district (connecting to **NH-334**). - **Ending Point: Judapur Dandu village** in **Prayagraj** district (connecting to **NH-19** near bypass). - **Inauguration Venue: Hardoi**. - **12 Districts Traversed (West to East):** 1. Meerut 2. Hapur 3. Bulandshahr 4. Amroha 5. Sambhal 6. Budaun 7. Shahjahanpur (includes a 3.5 km airstrip for emergency fighter landings) 8. Hardoi 9. Unnao 10. Raebareli 11. Pratapgarh 12. Prayagraj

Accidental Deaths in UP — NCRB ADSI 2024 Report (May 2026)

- In the **Accidental Deaths and Suicides in India (ADSI) 2024** report released by NCRB, **Uttar Pradesh** accounted for **9.2% of all accidental deaths in India**, ranking **3rd nationally** behind Maharashtra (16.2%) and Madhya Pradesh (9.8%).

Keep ready from older months

- State Budget ~**₹9.13 lakh crore**
- Padma names, especially **N Rajam**
- CCSU Meerut AI pilot
- Sarus crane census
- Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah) Ramsar

UP Personalities & High-Tech Milestones

Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla | Axiom-4 Pilot (Lucknow)

- **Hometown:** Born and raised in **Triveni Nagar, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh**.
- **Mission:** Served as the **Pilot** of Axiom Mission 4 (**Ax-4**) aboard SpaceX Crew Dragon **'Grace' (C213)** to the **International Space Station (ISS)** (launched 25 June 2025, returned 15 July 2025).
- **Distinction:** First Indian astronaut to visit the ISS; only the second Indian citizen in space after Wing Commander Rakesh Sharma (1984 aboard Soyuz T-11) after a **41-year hiatus**; the **first person from Uttar Pradesh in space**!

Weather Supercomputer 'Arunika' | NCMRWF, Noida

- **Location:** National Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasting (**NCMRWF**), Ministry of Earth Sciences, located in **Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar district, Uttar Pradesh)**.
- **Global Standing:** Ranked **#251 in the world** in the **TOP 500 Supercomputers list** (66th Edition, November 2025, SC25 St. Louis).
- **Compute Power:** Sustained performance (**Rmax**) of **5.94 PFlop/s** and peak performance (**Rpeak**) of **7.40 PFlop/s** with 203,040 processing cores.
- **National Standing:** Ranks as the **3rd fastest supercomputer in India** (behind AIRAWAT-PSAI at C-DAC Pune and Arka at IITM Pune).

May 2026

Jewar Airport timeline update

What happened April coverage had targeted commercial flights around **late May**. Operations actually began later, on **15 June 2026**, with the first IndiGo arrival from **Lucknow**. Keep May as the "target month that slipped" and revise the hard opening under June.

Still useful May–June UP facts

- Place: **Jewar**, **Gautam Buddha Nagar**.

- Airport name: **Noida International Airport**.
- First commercial airline in coverage: **IndiGo**.
- First city link highlighted: **Lucknow**, then onward to Bengaluru.

Ramsar confused-pair board

- **Patna Bird Sanctuary** — Etah (January).
- **Shekha Jheel** — Aligarh; India **99** / UP **12** (April).
- **Surha Tal / Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary** — Ballia; India **100** / UP **13** (June World Environment Day window).

Soft UP follow-ups

- Keep Dhanauri wetland near Jewar as a **policy conflict** story (Ramsar push vs airport bird-safety / biodiversity-park talk), not as a new Ramsar tag.
- Sarus crane remains the **state bird**.

June 2026

Surha Tal / Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary | Ballia | 100th Ramsar

What happened On **World Environment Day (5 June 2026)**, **Surha Tal** in **Ballia** became India's **100th** Ramsar site and Uttar Pradesh's **13th**. The announcement was celebrated at a WED programme in **Lucknow** with CM **Yogi Adityanath**.

Core facts

- District: **Ballia**.
- Official name: **Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary**.
- India **100** | UP **13**.
- Full ecology card → Environment.

> **Must-score UPPCS trio**

Etah (Patna) → Aligarh (Shekha / 99) → Ballia (Surha / 100).

UP Clean Air Management Project (UP CAMP) | WED 5 June 2026

What happened On the same World Environment Day stage in Lucknow, UP launched the **Uttar Pradesh Clean Air Management Project (UP CAMP)**.

Easy facts

- Outlay: about **₹2,741 crore**.
- Support partner often named: **World Bank**.
- Coverage called it India's **first airshed-based** clean-air initiative.
- Soft same-day package: **Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam** plantation drive 2026 and a docket on UP wetlands / Ramsar sites.

> **Easy wrong options**

Writing UP CAMP as a Central NCAP rename only. Putting the ₹2,741 crore figure on Surha Tal tourism instead of clean air.

Noida International Airport (Jewar) | commercial flights begin 15 June 2026

What happened Noida International Airport at **Jewar** began commercial operations on **15 June 2026**.

Core facts

- Place: **Jewar**, **Gautam Buddha Nagar**.
- First scheduled airline: **IndiGo**.
- First arrival highlighted: from **Lucknow** (Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport).
- Same aircraft then flew onward toward **Bengaluru** in coverage.
- Farmers who gave land travelled on a symbolic inaugural flight to Lucknow.

- Phase-1 cost often noted around **₹11,200 crore**.
- Early schedule aim: about **12** daily flights in June, rising toward about **40** in July.
- International flights targeted later in **2026**.

Soft YEIDA electronics note

YEIDA's proposed **Electronics Manufacturing Cluster** in Sector 10 (about **206 acres**) received environmental clearance from UP SEIAA in June coverage.

July 2026

Keep revising June's UP mega-facts

July's national spine was VB-G RAM G, India–UK CETA, Kusha, Vikram-1, and World Cup finals. For UPPCS, keep June cards hot:

- **Surha Tal / JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Ballia)** — India **100** / UP **13**
- **Jewar Airport** commercial start — **15 June**, IndiGo from Lucknow
- Confused pair: Etah (Patna) → Aligarh (Shekha / 99) → Ballia (Surha / 100)

Soft July UP follow-ups

- Watch for any state notification adopting **VB-G RAM G** wage rates / Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards.
- Jewar daily-flight ramp toward about **40** flights and later international services.
- Keep Dhanauri wetland vs airport safety as a soft environment–infra conflict, not a Ramsar tag.

August 2026

AK-203 'Sher' at Korwa, Amethi

What happened The first fully indigenous AK-203 rifle **Sher** was made and test-fired at **Korwa, Amethi**. This is a high-yield UP defence-manufacturing fact.

Core facts

- District / plant: **Amethi** / **Korwa**.
- Company: **IRRPL** (Indo-Russian JV).
- Full defence card → Science / Defence.

Soft women welfare note

UP coverage also flagged the **Lokmata Ahilyabai Matrushakti Yatra** idea and free bus travel for women aged **60+** in state messaging around the same window. Keep only as a soft state scheme fact until a full PIB-style card is needed.

Keep ready from older months

- Surha Tal (Ballia) — India **100** / UP **13**
- Shekha Jheel (Aligarh) — India **99** / UP **12**
- Jewar commercial flights from **15 June**
- Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah)
- Full Ramsar / money / confused-pair boards → Master tables

Ganga Expressway to Haridwar + Jhansi Link Expressway | late August 2026

What happened The UP Cabinet cleared two big road projects to grow the state's expressway network.

Ganga Expressway extension to Haridwar

- Aim: extend the Ganga Expressway toward **Haridwar** (Uttarakhand).
- Cost spoken in state briefs: about **₹10,761 crore** (state-funded).
- Design idea: six-lane greenfield road, expandable later.
- Why it matters: faster link between two Kumbh cities — **Prayagraj** and **Haridwar** — and better Bijnor–Haridwar travel.

Jhansi Link Expressway

- Cost: about **₹7,968 crore**.
- Length idea: about **103 km**.
- Link: **Jhansi** to the **Bundelkhand Expressway** near **Jalaun**.

UP Rankings in NCRB Crime in India 2024 & PAI 2.0 (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

NCRB Crime in India 2024 — UP-Specific Rankings

- **Crimes Against Women**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **66,398 registered cases** (followed by Maharashtra with 47,954 and West Bengal with 34,360 cases).
- **Dowry Deaths**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **2,038 cases** involving **2,057 victims** (followed by Bihar with 1,078 cases).
- **Atrocities Against Scheduled Castes (SC)**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **14,642 cases** registered under SC/ST (PoA) Act and related sections (highest absolute count nationally).

Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0 (PAI 2.0) — UP Highlights (MoPR, April 2026)

- **Framework**: Evaluates Gram Panchayats across 9 localized SDG themes.
- **B-Grade / 'Performer' Panchayats (Score 60 to <75)**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** in absolute count with **18,905 Panchayats** qualifying as 'Performers' (followed by Gujarat: 11,963; MP: 11,154).
- **D-Grade / 'Beginner' Panchayats (Score <40)**:
- **Uttar Pradesh had the highest absolute number** of beginner Panchayats in India at **6,124**, highlighting regional intra-state developmental divides.
- **National Context**: Across India, **zero (0)** Panchayats achieved the A+ (Achiever, $\ge$90) grade.

Republic Day 2026 — UP Tableau Milestone

- **Tableau Theme**: **"Culture of Bundelkhand"**
- **Focus**: Portrayed Bundelkhand's rich cultural and folk heritage together with modern development strides (Bundelkhand Expressway, Defence Industrial Corridor Jhansi node, and tap water transformation).
- **Accolade**: Won **2nd Prize in the Popular Choice category** (nationwide MyGov citizen voting), ranking just behind Gujarat (*Mantra of Swadeshi*).

AI-Led Innovation & BHASHINI Conference (Lucknow, Jan 2026)

- **Host & Venue**: **Lucknow** (held on **20 January 2026**).
- **Organisers**: Centre for e-Governance (CeG), Department of IT & Electronics, Government of Uttar Pradesh in collaboration with Digital India BHASHINI Division (MeitY).
- **Goal**: Accelerating voice-first, multilingual conversational AI tools across UP's e-governance systems and public service delivery in local dialects.

Uttar Pradesh "Gharauni Act" 2025 (Assented 2 January 2026)

- **Official Title**: *The Uttar Pradesh Rural Population (Abadi) Records Act, 2025*.
- **Core Purpose**: Provides statutory legal backing to rural residential (*abadi*) property records created under the **SVAMITVA** scheme (Ministry of Panchayati Raj).
- **UP SVAMITVA Milestones**:
- Targeted villages: **90,573** (100% drone survey completed).
- Property cards prepared in **68,377 villages**.
- Total *Gharauni* property cards generated in UP: **1,04,86,961 (over 1.04 crore cards!)** — highest in India.

Dharma Dhwaja Hoisting at Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Mandir (Ayodhya)

- **Date**: **25 November 2025** (Dhwajarohan Utsav attended by PM Narendra Modi during the auspicious *Abhijit Muhurta*).
- **Flag Specifications**: Saffron triangular flag, **10 feet high by 20 feet long**.

- **Three Sacred Emblems**: 1. **Radiant Sun**: Symbol of Lord Ram's Suryavanshi lineage. 2. **Om**: Spiritual connection between humanity and divinity. 3. **Kovidara Tree**: Emblem of Ayodhya's ancient dynasty and flag tradition.

Kashi Tamil Sangamam 4.0 (Varanasi — Dec 2025)

- **Dates & Venue**: **2 to 15 December 2025** in **Varanasi** (valedictory on 30 Dec 2025 attended by VP C.P. Radhakrishnan).
- **Central Theme**: **"Let Us Learn Tamil - Tamil Karkalam"** (focus on youth exchange and everyday spoken Tamil).
- **Knowledge Anchors**: Ministry of Education with **IIT Madras** and **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)**.

Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2025 — Full UP City Performance

- **Category-1 (>10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Agra**: **Rank 3** in India (Score: 196) (joint 3rd with Surat).
- **Kanpur**: **Rank 5** (Score: 192.2).
- **Prayagraj**: Rank 7 (Score: 188).
- **Varanasi**: Rank 11 (Score: 184).
- **Ghaziabad**: Rank 12 (Score: 183).
- **Lucknow**: Rank 15 (Score: 179).
- **Category-2 (3–10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Moradabad & Jhansi**: **Joint Rank 2** in India (Score: 198.5).
- **Gorakhpur & Firozabad**: Joint Rank 5 (Score: 195).
- **Bareilly**: Rank 7 (Score: 189.5).
- **Noida**: Rank 9 (Score: 184.2).
- **Category-3 (<3 Lakh Population)**:
- **Anpara (Sonbhadra)**: Rank 5 (Score: 187.5).
- **Rae Bareli**: Rank 7 (Score: 186.5).

Swachh Survekshan 2024–25 — UP Cities Complete Performance

- **Cleanest Ganga City**: **Prayagraj** declared India's **Cleanest Ganga City**.
- **Special Ministerial Recognition**: **Swachh Mahakumbh 2025** received a special ministerial recognition from MoHUA.
- **Safaimitra Surakshit Shehar (Sanitation Worker Safe City)**:
- **Gorakhpur**: **Rank 3** in India.
- **Prayagraj**: **Rank 5** in India.
- **Presidential Awardee (>10 Lakh Category)**:
- **Lucknow (Nagar Nigam)**: **Rank 3** in India (behind Ahmedabad and Bhopal).
- **Super Swachh League (3–10 Lakh Category)**:
- **Noida**: **Rank 5** in India (ahead of Chandigarh, Mysuru, Ujjain, Gandhinagar).
- **Top 20 Cities (>10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Lucknow**: 3rd | **Agra**: 10th | **Ghaziabad**: 11th | **Prayagraj**: 12th | **Kanpur**: 13th | **Varanasi**: 17th.
- **Top 20 Cities (3–10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Gorakhpur**: 4th | **Moradabad**: 10th | **Mathura-Vrindavan**: 11th | **Firozabad**: 12th | **Saharanpur**: 16th | **Jhansi**: 17th | **Bareilly**: 20th.

Lucknow Metro Rail Project Phase-1B (East-West Corridor)

- **Cabinet Approval**: Approved by Union Cabinet on **12 August 2025**.
- **Sanctioned Cost**: **₹5,801 crore**.
- **Route & Alignment**: Connects **Charbagh to Vasant Kunj** (traversing the densely populated heritage areas of Old Lucknow).
- **Route Specifications**: Total length **11.165 km** with **12 stations** (**7 underground and 5 elevated**).
- **Total Network**: Upon operationalisation of Phase 1B, Lucknow's total active metro operational network will expand to **34 km**.

Myanmar President Tours NETRA Complex (Greater Noida)

- **Event**: During his official State Visit to India (30 May – 3 June 2026), Myanmar President **U Min Aung Hlaing** toured the **NTPC Energy Technology Research Alliance (NETRA)** complex located in **Greater Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar district)** to observe clean energy, hydrogen, and renewable technology R&D.

IIT Kanpur & Vietnam National University (VNU) Research MoU

- **Agreement Date**: **18 September 2025** in Kanpur.
- **Core Scope**: Bilateral academic and technological partnership between **IIT Kanpur** and **Vietnam National University** focusing on **AI, smart city systems, drone technology, AI-driven healthcare, and agricultural drone applications**.
- **Key Delegations**: Included Dr. Nguyen Thu Huong (Vice Rector) and Prof. Nguyen Dinh Duc (Dean of Civil Engineering, VNU).

IIT Kanpur in QS World University Rankings 2027

- **Global Milestone**: **IIT Kanpur** maintained its global standing at **Rank 222** in the QS World University Rankings 2027, standing as Uttar Pradesh's highest-ranked premier higher education institution globally.

16th Finance Commission (2026–31) — UP Awarded Highest Devolution Share in India

- **Chairman**: **Dr. Arvind Panagariya** (tabled in Parliament 1 February 2026).
- **UP Devolution Percentage**: **17.62%** of the net divisible pool of Union taxes.
- **National Distinction**: **Rank #1 in India** (Highest share among all 28 States), significantly ahead of Bihar (2nd: 9.95%), Madhya Pradesh (3rd: 7.85%), Maharashtra (4th: 6.44%), and Rajasthan (5th: 5.93%).
- **Grants Share**: UP also stands as the largest single beneficiary state under the recommended **₹9.47 lakh crore** local bodies and disaster grants pool.

PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY) — UP Tops with 12 Districts

- **Approval Date**: Union Cabinet approved the scheme on **16 July 2025** for a 6-year period (FY 2025–26 to FY 2030–31).
- **Aspirational Agriculture Districts**: Out of 100 districts identified nationwide on **3 October 2025** across 29 States/UTs, **Uttar Pradesh has 12 districts — HIGHEST IN INDIA** (surpassing Maharashtra: 9, Madhya Pradesh: 8, Rajasthan: 8, and Bihar: 7).
- **Core Focus**: Targeted saturation of irrigation, high-yield certified seeds, digital agriculture, post-harvest warehouses, and agro-processing in UP's agri-backward regions.

Civil Registration System (CRS) 2023 — UP Vital Statistics (ORGI, Oct 2025)

- **Birth Registration Level in UP**: **89.1%** (National average: 98.4%).
- **Death Registration Level in UP**: **80.0%** (National average: 97.2%).
- **Total Registered Births in UP**: Approximately **49.70 lakh births** (comprising 26,14,000 male and 23,56,000 female births).
- **Total Registered Deaths in UP**: Approximately **12.30 lakh deaths**.
- **Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB) in UP**: **902 females per 1,000 males** (among major states, one of the lowest alongside Jharkhand 899, Bihar 900, Telangana 906; National highest: Arunachal Pradesh 1,085).

Sample Registration System (SRS) Bulletin 2024 — UP Specifics (ORGI, May 2026)

- **Crude Birth Rate (CBR)**: **24.7 per 1,000 population** in UP (ranked **2nd highest in India** among major states, behind Bihar's 26.8; National average: 18.3).
- **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)**: **34 infant deaths per 1,000 live births** in UP (ranked **3rd highest in India** behind Chhattisgarh's 36 and Madhya Pradesh's 35; National average: 24).

Third Advance Estimates of Agricultural Crops 2025–26 — UP Triple Crown (#1 in Rice, Wheat, Sugarcane)

- **Source**: Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare (Released 27 May 2026).
- **Rice Production**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **198.05 lakh tonnes** (surpassing Telangana: 185.29L tonnes and West Bengal: 171.36L tonnes).
- **Wheat Production**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **358.77 lakh tonnes** (far ahead of Madhya Pradesh: 264.43L tonnes and Punjab: 170.79L tonnes).
- **Sugarcane Production**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **2,296.99 lakh tonnes** (commanding a dominant lead over Maharashtra: 1,316.49L tonnes and Karnataka: 572.88L tonnes).

Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics (BAHS) 2025 — UP Milk & Meat Leadership

- **Source**: Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying, MoFAHD (Released 26 November 2025 on National Milk Day).
- **Milk Production**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** contributing **15.66%** of total national milk production (followed by Rajasthan: 14.82%, Madhya Pradesh: 9.12%, Gujarat: 7.78%, Maharashtra: 6.71%).
- **Meat Production**:

- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #2 in India** contributing **12.20%** of total national meat output (closely following West Bengal at #1 with 12.46%; ahead of Maharashtra: 11.57% and Andhra Pradesh: 10.84%).

States' Startup Ranking Framework 5.0 (SRF 5.0) — UP as 'Top Performer'

- **Announced by**: DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce and Industry (evaluating 34 States/UTs).
- **UP Category**: Category A (States with population > 1 crore).
- **UP Standing**: **Uttar Pradesh adjudged as 'Top Performer'** alongside Karnataka, Punjab, and Tamil Nadu (Gujarat was 'Best Performer').

NITI Aayog Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2026 — UP as 'Front-Runner' State

- **Released on**: 11 March 2026 by NITI Aayog (assessing 5 pillars: Quality of Expenditure, Revenue Mobilisation, Fiscal Prudence, Debt Index, Debt Sustainability).
- **UP Standing**: **Uttar Pradesh classified in the 'Front-Runners' category** among major states, sharing honors with Gujarat, Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, and Karnataka (Achievers: Odisha, Goa, Jharkhand).

NITI Aayog Export Preparedness Index (EPI) 2024 — UP #1 Landlocked State

- **Released on**: 14 January 2026 by NITI Aayog (4th edition, evaluated across 4 pillars: Policy, Infrastructure, Business Ecosystem, Export Performance).
- **Overall Large States Rank**: **Rank #4 in India** (behind coastal heavyweights Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Gujarat; ahead of Andhra Pradesh).
- **Landlocked Champion**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 among ALL LANDLOCKED STATES in India**!
- **Core Drivers Praised**: **One District One Product (ODOP)** initiative, comprehensive logistics policy reforms, expressway and inland multimodal logistics hubs/dry ports, and dedicated exporter handholding cells.

Union Budget 2026–27 — High-Speed Rail & Waterway Infrastructure for UP

- **High-Speed Rail Corridors**: Among the 7 high-speed rail corridors announced nationally, two major corridors anchor in Uttar Pradesh: 1. **Delhi–Varanasi High-Speed Rail Corridor** 2. **Varanasi–Siliguri High-Speed Rail Corridor** (linking Eastern UP to North-East India).
- **Inland Waterways & Ship Repair Hub**: Under the 20 new National Waterways initiative, a dedicated **regional training centre and modern inland vessel ship-repair ecosystem** was sanctioned for **Varanasi** (alongside Patna on NW-1 Ganga).

Uttar Pradesh Achieves 13 Ramsar Sites Milestone (World Environment Day 2026)

- **100th Ramsar Site of India**: **Jai Prakash Narayan (Surha Tal) Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh**, was designated as India's **100th Ramsar site** on **5 June 2026 (World Environment Day)**.
- A large natural freshwater wetland in the middle Ganga floodplain, vital for migratory waterfowl and indigenous fisheries.
- **99th Ramsar Site of India**: **Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Aligarh district, Uttar Pradesh** (17 km from Aligarh; notified 19 January 2026; hosts 249 bird species on the Central Asian Flyway).
- **Recent Preceding Addition**: **Patna Bird Sanctuary** in **Etah district** (notified 4 December 2025; UP's smallest bird sanctuary at ~108 hectares).
- **National Ranking**: **Uttar Pradesh ranks #2 in India with 13 Ramsar sites** (surpassed only by Tamil Nadu with 20 sites).

#	Ramsar Wetland Name	District in Uttar Pradesh	Designation / Notification Date
1	Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora stretch)	Bulandshahr, Hapur, Sambhal	8 November 2005
2	Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary (Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad)	Unnao	19 September 2019
3	Sarsai Nawar Jheel	Etawah	19 September 2019
4	Samaspur Bird Sanctuary	Rae Bareli	3 October 2019
5	Sandi Bird Sanctuary	Hardoi	26 September 2019
6	Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary	Gonda	2 December 2019
7	Saman Bird Sanctuary	Mainpuri	2 December 2019
8	Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)	Agra	21 August 2020
9	Haiderpur Wetland	Muzaffarnagar & Bijnor	13 April 2021
10	Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary	Sant Kabir Nagar	29 June 2021

#	Ramsar Wetland Name	District in Uttar Pradesh	Designation / Notification Date
11	Patna Bird Sanctuary	Etah	4 December 2025
12	Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary (99th in India)	Aligarh	19 January 2026
13	Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary / Surha Tal (100th in India)	Ballia	5 June 2026

IQAir World Air Quality Report 2025 — Loni (UP) Ranked #1 Most Polluted Globally

- **Global #1 City**: **Loni (Ghaziabad district, Uttar Pradesh)** was ranked as the **world's most polluted city** in the IQAir 2025 Report with an annual average PM2.5 concentration of **112.5 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (far exceeding the WHO annual guideline of 5 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$).

Ganga Expressway Inauguration (29 April 2026 | Hardoi)

- **Inaugurated by**: Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** on **April 29, 2026** in **Hardoi district**.
- **Foundation Stone**: Laid on **18 December 2021** in Shahjahanpur; construction commenced April 2022 under a **Public-Private Partnership (PPP)** framework.
- **Length & Alignment**: **594 km long**, access-controlled greenfield expressway corridor with 6 lanes (expandable to 8 lanes), designed for speeds up to 120 km/h.
- **Total Project Cost**: Estimated at **₹36,230 crore**.
- **12 Traversed Districts**: Traverses 12 districts from Western to Eastern Uttar Pradesh: 1. **Meerut** (Starting point) 2. **Hapur** 3. **Bulandshahr** 4. **Amroha** 5. **Sambhal** 6. **Badaun** 7. **Shahjahanpur** 8. **Hardoi** (Inauguration venue) 9. **Unnao** 10. **Rae Bareli** 11. **Pratapgarh** 12. **Prayagraj** (Terminating point).

North Tech Symposium 2026 (Prayagraj, UP)

- **Inaugurated by**: Raksha Mantri **Rajnath Singh** on **May 4, 2026** in **Prayagraj**.
- **Central Theme**: *"Raksha Triveni Sangam – Where Technology, Industry & Soldiering Converge"*.
- **Organizers**: Jointly organized by the **Northern Command and Central Command** of the Indian Army, alongside the **Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM)**.

India's First Basmati & Organic Training-cum-Demo Farm (Pilibhit, UP)

- **Institutional Agreement**: The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (**APEDA**) signed a **70-year long-term lease agreement** to establish India's first integrated Basmati and organic training-cum-demonstration farm in **Pilibhit district, Uttar Pradesh**.
- **Mandate**: Advance sustainable export-grade organic Basmati cultivation, certified farm training, and zero-residue agriculture.

Parveen Shaikh Wins 2026 Whitley Award ("Green Oscar")

- **Prestigious Honor**: **Parveen Shaikh** won the **2026 Whitley Award** (commonly known as the **"Green Oscar"**).
- **Conservation Achievement**: Spearheaded community-led conservation of the endangered **Indian Skimmer** (*Rynchops albicollis*).
- **Institutional Link & UP Geography**: Associated with the **Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS)**; her highly successful "Guardian" conservation model is being expanded **along the Ganga River to Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh**.

Minimum Wage Revision in Uttar Pradesh (April 2026)

- **Statutory Notification**: Notified by Uttar Pradesh Government on **17 April 2026** with retrospective effect from **1 April 2026**, under the **Minimum Wages Act, 1948** and the **United Provinces Industrial Disputes Act, 1947**.
- **Three Geographical Tiers**:
- **Category I**: **Gautam Buddha Nagar and Ghaziabad** (industrial concentration & high cost of living).
- **Category II**: Districts containing **Municipal Corporations** (*Nagar Nigams*).
- **Category III**: Remaining districts of the State.
- **Category I Monthly Wage Slabs** (Basic + Variable Dearness Allowance):
- *Unskilled Labour*: **₹13,690**
- *Semi-skilled Labour*: **₹15,059**
- *Skilled Labour*: **₹16,868**.

Fruit Horizon 2026 Conclave (Lucknow, UP)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held on **6–7 May 2026** in **Lucknow**.
- **Scope**: Two-day national conclave focused on transforming India into a global export powerhouse in premium horticulture, GI-tagged subtropical fruits, and cold-chain infrastructure.

'Visit My State' Tourism Campaign (Uttar Pradesh)

- **Launch Date**: Launched on **13 May 2026** by Uttar Pradesh Tourism Minister **Jaiveer Singh**.
- **Citizen Benefit**: State-run museums across Uttar Pradesh offer **free entry to children and families for two months** to boost domestic heritage tourism and empower local artisans.

Uttar Pradesh Budget 2026–27 Master Dossier (Presented 11 February 2026)

- **Presented by**: Finance Minister **Suresh Kumar Khanna** in the UP Legislative Assembly on **11 February 2026**.
- **Macroeconomic Target**: Geared towards fulfilling the vision of transforming Uttar Pradesh into a **$1 Trillion Economy**.
- **GSDP Projections**:
- Projected GSDP for 2026–27 at current prices: **₹39.8 lakh crore** (a 28% increase over the revised estimate of 2025–26).
- Real GSDP growth at constant prices in 2024–25: **9.0%** (surpassing the national GDP expansion rate of 6.5%).
- GSDP Sectoral Structure (2024–25): **Agriculture: 27%**, **Industry/Manufacturing: 26%**, **Services: 47%**.
- **UP Per Capita GSDP (2024–25)**: Estimated at **₹1,24,366** (up by 11.6% over 2023–24; national per capita GDP: ₹2,34,859).
- **Budget Dimensions & Key Aggregates**:
- **Total Budget Outlay (Gross Expenditure)**: **₹9,12,696 crore** (27% expansion over RE 2025–26).
- **Debt Repayment**: ₹61,795 crore; **Net Policy Expenditure**: **₹8,50,901 crore**.
- **Total Receipts**: **₹8,48,233 crore** (Net receipts excluding public debt borrowings: ₹7,32,420 crore).
- **Revenue Surplus**: Budgeted at **₹64,458 crore (1.6% of GSDP)** (maintains continuous revenue surplus status).
- **Fiscal Deficit**: Budgeted at **₹1,18,481 crore (exactly 3.0% of GSDP)** — strictly conforming to the **16th Finance Commission's 3.0% GSDP fiscal deficit ceiling** for states.
- **Primary Deficit**: Budgeted at **₹49,560 crore (1.2% of GSDP)**.
- **Outstanding Debt/Liabilities**: Estimated to decline to **23.1% of GSDP** by end of 2026–27 (down from 27.6% in 2025–26 RE).
- **Revenue Structure & State Tax Mobilization**:
- Total Revenue Receipts: **₹7,28,928 crore** (50% raised from own state resources, 50% from Central transfers/grants).
- **State's Own Tax Revenue**: Budgeted at **₹3,34,491 crore** (+48% over RE 2025–26).
  - **State GST (SGST)**: **₹1,49,956 crore** (largest internal tax pillar, contributing **45%** of own tax revenue).
  - **State Excise**: **₹71,278 crore** (+17% over RE).
  - **Sales Tax / VAT**: **₹48,115 crore**.
  - **Stamp & Registration Fees**: **₹43,802 crore**.
  - **Taxes on Motor Vehicles**: **₹15,808 crore**.
- **State's Own Non-Tax Revenue**: Budgeted at **₹26,754 crore**.
- **Central Devolution**: Share in Central Taxes: **₹2,68,911 crore**; Grants-in-Aid from Centre: **₹98,772 crore**.
- **Rupee Flows (B.E. 2026–27 Percentage Shares)**:
- **Rupee Comes In (Sources)**: State's Own Tax Revenue: **39.0%**, Share in Central Taxes: **31.4%**, Public Debt Borrowings: **13.5%**, Central Grants: **11.5%**, Non-Tax Revenue: **3.1%**, Public Account Net: **1.1%**, Recovery of Loans: **0.4%**.
- **Rupee Goes Out (Expenditure)**: Capital Outlay / Infra: **19.4%**, Salaries (Govt): **11.2%**, Salaries (Aided Institutions): **8.9%** (Total Salaries: 20.1%), Pensions: **11.1%**, Interest Payments: **7.6%**, Public Debt Loan Repayment: **6.8%**, Grants-in-Aid: **6.1%**, Subsidies: **4.7%**, Local Bodies Assignment: **4.1%**, Loans & Advances: **1.0%**, Other Operational Spending: **19.1%**.
- **Key Sectoral Outlays & Major Scheme Allocations**:
- **Education, Sports, Arts & Culture**: **₹1,08,154 crore** (largest sectoral allocation, +28% over RE). Primary education assistance: ₹55,792 crore; Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan: ₹7,738 crore.
- **Energy**: **₹56,621 crore** (Power subsidy: ₹21,500 crore).
- **Health and Family Welfare**: **₹53,326 crore** (Rural allopathy: ₹6,818 crore; Urban allopathy: ₹5,793 crore).
- **Transport & Roads**: **₹50,391 crore** (Capital outlay on roads and bridges: **₹38,592 crore**).

- **Rural Development**: **₹49,044 crore** (+59% over RE; PMAY-Gramin: ₹6,102 crore; MGNREGS: ₹5,544 crore; NRLM/Aajeevika: ₹4,580 crore).
- **Social Welfare & Nutrition**: **₹42,263 crore** (Old age / farmer pensions: ₹8,950 crore; Destitute Women Pension: ₹3,500 crore).
- **Police & Public Safety**: **₹41,898 crore**.
- **Agriculture and Allied**: **₹30,938 crore** (Private tubewell free power subsidy: ₹2,400 crore; Solar pump conversion: ₹638 crore).
- **Urban Development**: **₹27,532 crore** (PMAY-Urban: ₹6,842 crore).

Uttar Pradesh Economic Survey 2025–26 Master Findings (Presented 9 February 2026)

- **Macro Vision**: Presented on **9 February 2026**; details UP's structural roadmap toward achieving a **$1 Trillion Gross State Domestic Product**.
- **GSDP Expansion Trajectory**:
- GSDP at current prices rose from ₹13.30 lakh crore (2016–17) to **₹30.25 lakh crore in 2024–25 (Quick Estimates)** — clocking a phenomenal **CAGR of 10.8% over 8 years**.
- GSDP for 2025–26 estimated at approximately **₹36 lakh crore**.
- **Contribution to National Economy**: Uttar Pradesh contributes **9.1% of India's total Gross Domestic Product**.
- **Structural Shifts in State Economy (2017–18 to 2024–25)**:
- **Primary Sector**: 25.9% $\to$ **25.8%** (resilient, stable baseline).
- **Secondary Sector**: 25.4% $\to$ **27.2%** (expanded rapidly driven by mega expressways, industrial corridors, and manufacturing).
- **Tertiary Sector**: 48.8% $\to$ **47.0%** (healthy restructuring toward high-value manufacturing while retaining services dominance).
- *Comparison with India*: National secondary sector contracted from 27.0% to 25.3%, whereas UP's industrial share expanded to 27.2%!
- **Demographics & Population Profile (March 2026 Baseline)**:
- Total Estimated Population: **25.19 crore**:
  - Represents **17.8% of India's total population** (141.51 crore).
  - Represents **3.0% of the entire world population** (830 crore).
  - **Global Scale**: If Uttar Pradesh were an independent sovereign nation, it would be the **5th most populous country in the world** (behind only India, China, USA at 33.5 cr, and Indonesia at 27.7 cr; ahead of Pakistan, Nigeria, and Brazil!).
- **Demographic Transition & Fertility**:
  - Population annual growth rate decelerated from 1.85% (2011) to 1.70% (2021), projected to drop sharply to **0.58% annually during 2026–2051**.
  - **Total Fertility Rate (TFR)**: Plummeted from 2.7 (NFHS-4, 2015–16) to **2.4 (NFHS-5, 2019–21)**, steadily approaching the demographic replacement rate of 2.1.
- **Life Expectancy Projections**:
  - Males: 62.5 years (2011) $\to$ projected **73.2 years** (2051).
  - Females: 65.0 years (2011) $\to$ projected **77.1 years** (2051).
- **Fiscal Autonomy & Per Capita Wealth**:
- **Declining Central Dependence**: Reliance on Central tax devolution dropped from **56.0% in 2016–17 down to 46.4% in 2025–26**, showing increasing financial self-reliance.
- **State Own Tax Revenue**: Rose from ₹0.86 lakh crore (2016–17) to **₹2.09 lakh crore in 2024–25** (a 2.5-fold leap; CAGR 14.7%).
- **Per Capita Net Income**: Rose from ₹54,564 (2016–17) to **₹1,09,844 in 2024–25** (CAGR 9.1%; between 2020–21 and 2024–25 growth accelerated to 14.7%). Gross per capita income reached **₹1,26,304**.
- **Agriculture & Allied Performance**:
- Agricultural GVA expanded from ₹2.96 lakh crore (2016–17) to **₹6.95 lakh crore in 2024–25 (CAGR 11.2%)**.
- Composition of Agri GVA: **Crops: 67.4%**, **Livestock: 24.7%**, **Forestry: 4.5%**, **Fisheries: 3.5%**.
- Total foodgrain output in 2024–25 reached **737.4 lakh metric tonnes** (+9.9% year-on-year).
- Milk production expanded by 33.6% (cementing UP's **#1 rank nationally**); egg production jumped by 167%.

- **Forestry Expansion**:
- Forest and tree cover expanded from 23,437.53 sq km (ISFR 2021) to **23,996.72 sq km** (ISFR 2023), a net gain of **559.19 sq km (+2.39%)**.
- **Uttar Pradesh ranks 2nd in India in net increase of forest and tree cover**!
- **Infrastructure, Transport & Digital Connectivity**:
- **Expressway Capital**: UP leads India with **7 operational expressways**, 3 under construction, and 12 proposed corridors.
- **Aviation Leadership**: Houses 12 domestic airports and **4 operational international airports** (Lucknow, Varanasi, Kushinagar, Ayodhya). With Noida International Airport (Jewar), UP will become the **first state in India with 5 international airports**.
- **National Highway Network**: Encompasses **12,123 km of National Highways** traversed by **90 designated National Highways**.
- **Urban Ropeway**: India's first urban passenger ropeway project is under execution in **Varanasi**.
- **Digital Connectivity Crown**: Uttar Pradesh ranks **#1 in India in total internet subscribers** with **13.82 crore active internet connections** (as of September 2025–26).
- **Tourism Transformation (Maha Kumbh Factor)**:
- Total tourist arrivals skyrocketed from 64.91 crore in 2024 to **156.18 crore tourists in 2025 (a 2.4-fold surge)**, powered by the Prayagraj Maha Kumbh.
- **UP overtook Tamil Nadu to become #1 in India in domestic tourist visits** (UP's national share of domestic tourists expanded from 16.2% in 2021 $\to$ 18.4% in 2022 $\to$ 19.1% in 2023 $\to$ **21.9% in 2024**).

Uttar Pradesh Schemes, Institutions & Governance Landmarks (2025–2026)

UP Navayug Palika Yojana (Approved March 2026)

- **Objective**: Expand the Smart City Mission to second-tier urban centers across the state.
- **Coverage**: Implemented across urban local bodies in **58 district headquarters** (55 municipal councils, 3 town councils, and Dadri Municipal Council in Gautam Buddha Nagar).
- **Funding & Outlay**: **₹583.20 crore annually**, totaling **₹2,916 crore over five years (2025–26 to 2029–30)**.
- **Key Feature**: **100% fully state-funded** with zero Central Government financial participation; focuses on e-governance, digital municipal services, mechanized sanitation, and smart urban infrastructure.

Project GANGA (Broadband Connectivity)

- **Full Form**: **Government Assisted Network for Growth and Advancement (GANGA)**.
- **Coverage**: Launched in March 2026 to deliver high-speed optical broadband connectivity to **20 lakh households** across urban and rural UP over 2–3 years.
- **Grassroots Model**: Trains 8,000 to 10,000 rural youth as **Digital Service Providers (DSPs)** at the Nyaya Panchayat level to manage village internet services.

Nivesh Mitra 3.0 & Industrial Parks Infrastructure (March 2026)

- **Platform**: Upgraded digital single-window clearances via **Nivesh Mitra 3.0** launched by CM Yogi Adityanath on 24 March 2026.
- **New Schemes**: Unveiled the **'UP Private Business Park Development Scheme-2025'** and the **'Plug-and-Play Industrial Sheds Scheme'** to accelerate MSME factory setups.

Uttar Pradesh AI Mission & Lucknow AI City

- **State AI Mission**: Announced at the Regional AI Impact Conference (Lucknow, Jan 2026) with a dedicated state outlay of **₹2,000 crore over 3 years**.
- **Lucknow AI City Project**: Envisages an investment of **₹10,732 crore** to develop India's first dedicated AI City in Lucknow, featuring a 10,000-GPU compute cluster, multimodal Indian language labs, and incubation hubs.

86th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC)

- **Venue & Dates**: Hosted by the UP Legislature at Vidhan Bhawan, **Lucknow from 19 to 21 January 2026**.
- **Dignitaries**: Inaugurated by UP Governor Anandiben Patel and addressed by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla; focused on leveraging technology for paperless legislative proceedings and legislator capacity building.

Jan Bhavan (Governor's Residence Renamed)

- **Historic Renaming**: On **21 January 2026**, the Uttar Pradesh Government officially renamed the official residence of the Governor in Lucknow from **Raj Bhavan to 'Jan Bhavan'** (People's House).

One District-One Cuisine (ODOC) Initiative

- **Launch Event**: Launched by Union Home Minister Amit Shah on **Uttar Pradesh Day (24 January 2026)** at Rashtra Prerna Sthal, Lucknow.
- **Concept**: Modeled on the ODOP success; identifies, standardizes, brands, and exports the distinctive traditional cuisine and culinary delicacies of each of UP's 75 districts.

Uttar Pradesh Gaurav Samman 2025–26

- **Presented on**: UP Day (**24 January 2026**); carries a cash prize of **₹11 lakh, citation, and shawl** each.
- **Five Distinguished Recipients**: 1. **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla** (Lucknow): Space Science & Aviation (Axiom-4 mission astronaut pilot). 2. **Alakh Pandey** (Prayagraj): Education & EdTech (Founder & CEO of Physics Wallah). 3. **Dr. Hari Om Panwar**: Hindi Literature and poetry. 4. **Rashmi Arya**: Social Work & Women Empowerment. 5. **Dr. Sudhanshu Singh**: Agricultural Science and rural crop research.

Rashtra Prerna Sthal (Lucknow)

- **Inauguration**: Dedicated by PM Narendra Modi on **25 December 2025** on the **101st birth anniversary of former PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee** in Lucknow.

First Zero Fresh Waste Dump City in UP

- **Recognition**: **Lucknow** became the **first city in Uttar Pradesh** to achieve the milestone of being certified as a **Zero Fresh Waste Dump City** under Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban), processing 100% of its daily municipal waste (2,000 MT/day) at the Shivri treatment plant.

India's First Glass Museum (Firozabad)

- **Location**: Established in **Firozabad**, globally renowned as the "Suhag Nagari" / "Glass City of India", cataloguing centuries of traditional glass-blowing crafts and modern scientific glass innovations.

India's First Dedicated Forest University (Gorakhpur)

- **Establishment**: UP Government announced India's first dedicated **Forest University** in **Gorakhpur** with an initial outlay of **₹500 crore**, focusing on forestry science, wildlife habitat management, and climate research.

Uttar Pradesh's First Municipal Space Lab (Padrauna)

- **Location**: Established at **Padrauna in Kushinagar district** by the Padrauna Municipal Council in partnership with Vyomika Space, offering hands-on astronomical instrumentation for rural schoolchildren.

Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary Declared Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ)

- **Notification**: Declared an **Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ)** by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change; situated in **Gonda district, Uttar Pradesh** (also an accredited Ramsar site).

Lucknow Designated UNESCO "Creative City of Gastronomy"

- **International Honor**: Designated by UNESCO on **31 October 2025** (World Cities Day) as a member of the UNESCO Creative Cities Network (UCCN) in the **Gastronomy** category for its Awadhi culinary heritage.
- **National Context**: Lucknow is the **second city in India** to receive this gastronomic honor, following **Hyderabad (designated in 2019)**.

India's First MWh-Scale Vanadium Redox Flow Battery (VRFB)

- **Location & Commissioning**: Inaugurated on **11 November 2025** in **Greater Noida** by the Union Minister for Power and Housing & Urban Affairs.
- **Capacity & Developer**: **3 MWh** commercial energy storage facility engineered by **NTPC NETRA** (National Energy Technology Research Alliance) for large-scale grid storage.

India's First 'Solar on Track' System (Duhai, Ghaziabad)

- **Installation**: Deployed by NCRTC in November 2025 at the Namo Bharat RRTS Depot in **Duhai, Ghaziabad** — first application of railway track-mounted solar panels on any metro or high-speed rail corridor in India.

State Institute of Hotel Management (SIHM) in Gorakhpur

- **Sanction**: UP's first State Institute of Hotel Management sanctioned for **Gorakhpur** to train professionals for the burgeoning Purvanchal Buddhist Circuit tourism.

India's First Government Hospital-Based AI Clinic (GIMS Greater Noida)

- **Medical Innovation**: Launched at the **Government Institute of Medical Sciences (GIMS) in Greater Noida**; deploys AI-based genomic analysis, rapid digital pathology, and medical imaging screening.

India's First AI-Enabled State University Pilot (CCSU Meerut)

- **Academic Debut**: Unveiled on **28 January 2026** at **Chaudhary Charan Singh University (CCSU), Meerut** in partnership with MSDE, Google Cloud, and Placecom.

North India's First Semiconductor Unit (Gautam Buddha Nagar)

- **Groundbreaking**: Foundation stone laid by PM Narendra Modi on **21 February 2026** in **Gautam Buddha Nagar**.
- **Joint Venture**: Partnership between **HCL and Foxconn** involving an investment of approximately **₹3,700 crore** for specialized outsourced semiconductor assembly and test (OSAT) packaging.

Namo Bharat Rapid Rail & Meerut Metro Inauguration

- **Commissioning**: Inaugurated by PM Narendra Modi on **22 February 2026** in **Meerut**, integrating regional high-speed transit with intra-city metro rail on common track infrastructure.

Purvanchal's First Yarn Processing Plant (Mirzapur)

- **Establishment**: Sited in **Mirzapur district** to supply locally processed, dye-treated synthetic and woollen yarn directly to the GI-tagged hand-knotted carpet hubs of Mirzapur and Bhadohi.

Bareilly Airport Tops UP in Customer Satisfaction Survey

- **Aviation Ranking**: **Bareilly Airport** clinched the **#1 rank in Uttar Pradesh** and **7th rank nationally** in the Airports Authority of India (AAI) Customer Satisfaction Index (National #1 shared by Bhopal and Khajuraho).

UP's First-Ever Dedicated Excise Export Policy 2026–29

- **Policy Approved**: Approved on **13 February 2026**; Uttar Pradesh became the **first state in India to notify an independent, export-oriented excise regulatory policy** for grain distilleries and alcoholic beverages.

India's First National Cow Culture Museum (Mathura)

- **Institution**: Established on the campus of **Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Pashu Chikitsa Vigyan Vishwavidyalaya in Mathura**, preserving the germplasm history and physical models of 100 indigenous bovine breeds.

India–France National Centre of Excellence in Aeronautics (Kanpur)

- **Sanction**: PM Narendra Modi announced the **National Centre of Excellence (NCoE) for Skilling in Aeronautics and Defence** at the **National Skill Training Institute (NSTI) in Kanpur**.

Two New State Universities Established in UP (February 2026)

- **Legislation**: UP Legislative Assembly passed enabling Acts on **16 February 2026** establishing: 1. **Kashi Naresh State University in Bhadohi** 2. **Swami Shukdevanand State University in Shahjahanpur**.

Eparchaean Unconformity at Kalinjar Fort Declared Geo-Heritage Site

- **Designation**: Geological Survey of India (**GSI**) formally declared the **Eparchaean Unconformity near Kalinjar Fort in Banda district** as a **National Geo-Heritage Site of National Importance** on **6 March 2026** during GSI's 176th Foundation Day.

Varanasi Sets Guinness World Record for Tree Plantation

- **World Record**: On **1 March 2026**, Varanasi planted **2,51,446 saplings in a single hour** (surpassing China's 2018 record of 1.53 lakh trees) to create the urban green lung called **"Namo Van"**.

Second Rangewide Dolphin Estimation Launched from Bijnor

- **Wildlife Census**: MoEFCC rolled out the nationwide second dolphin census under **Project Dolphin** on **17 January 2026 starting from Bijnor, UP** along the Upper Ganga stretch (coordinated by WII Dehradun).

72nd National Volleyball Tournament (Varanasi)

- **Event**: Inaugurated virtually by PM Modi on **4 January 2026** at the **Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Stadium in Varanasi** featuring 58 national teams.

First State-Level Braille Library in UP

- **Location**: Inaugurated on **4 January 2026** at **Dr. Shakuntala Misra National Rehabilitation University (DSMNRU) in Lucknow**, housing over 4,000 Braille reference volumes.

UP Tops Business Deregulation 1.0 Rankings

- **National Honors**: Uttar Pradesh was ranked **#1 in India** by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) for cutting bureaucratic compliance across 23 key commercial sectors.

Divya Singh (Gorakhpur) Cycles to Everest Base Camp

- **Mountaineering Feat**: 28-year-old schoolteacher **Divya Singh from Gorakhpur** became the **first Indian woman and second woman globally** to cycle all the way to Mount Everest Base Camp (completed in 14 days).

700-kg Vikramaditya Vedic Clock Installed in Kashi Vishwanath

- **Cultural Landmark**: A massive 700-kg Vedic clock calculating traditional *Panchang* and celestial time was installed at **Kashi Vishwanath Temple in Varanasi** in April 2026, gifted by Madhya Pradesh CM Mohan Yadav.

India's First Indigenous Hydrogen-Powered Water Taxi (Varanasi)

- **Green Maritime Transport**: Flagged off by Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal on **11 December 2025 in Varanasi** on the Ganga River; powered by hydrogen fuel cell modules with zero tailpipe carbon emissions.

16th Hockey India Sub-Junior Men National Championship (Gold for UP)

- **Sports Glory**: Held at **Rajgir Sports Complex (Bihar)** in 2026; **Uttar Pradesh won the Gold Medal** by defeating Madhya Pradesh **5–2** in the final (Silver: MP; Bronze: Punjab).

ABDM Scan-and-Share OPD Registrations (UP Ranked #2 in India)

- **Digital Health Milestone**: In the National Health Authority's Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) rankings, Uttar Pradesh secured the **#2 rank in India** with **2.25 crore online OPD registrations** generated via Scan-and-Share QR codes (standing second only to Bihar's 2.94 crore out of 11.38 crore national registrations).

October 2026

PM Modi's Varanasi Mega-Package | 20 October 2026

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** visited his parliamentary constituency **Varanasi**, inaugurating and laying foundation stones for multiple development projects worth over **₹6,700 crore** spanning healthcare, sports infrastructure, civil aviation, and regional connectivity.

Key projects & core prelims facts - **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital (Harhua, Varanasi):** - Super-speciality 225-bed eye hospital established by Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Medical Trust. - Cross-subsidy model: 70% of surgeries and OPD consultations provided completely free of cost to the poor and underprivileged across Eastern UP, Bihar, and Jharkhand. - Equipped with advanced corneal transplantation, vitreoretinal, paediatric ophthalmology, and glaucoma care. - **Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex (Sigra Stadium Redevelopment):** - PM Modi inaugurated **Phases 2 and 3** of the Sigra Sports Complex redevelopment (costing over **₹210 crore**). - Executed under the **Khelo India scheme** and **Smart City Mission**. - Features an Olympic-size aquatic centre, multi-discipline indoor combat arena, athletics track, shooting ranges, and a high-performance athlete sports science centre. - **Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport (Babatpur, Varanasi) Expansion:** - Foundation stone laid for runway extension and a new terminal building worth approximately **₹2,870 crore**. - Runway lengthened from 2,750 metres to **4,075 metres**, enabling wide-body long-haul international flights (Boeing 777/787 and Airbus A350). - Terminal capacity will rise from 3.9 million passengers to **10 million passengers annually**. - **Airport Connectivity Enclaves across UP:** - Inauguration of the newly developed civil enclave at **Sarsawa Airport (Saharanpur)** under the regional connectivity scheme **UDAN**. - Foundation stones for civil enclaves and new terminals at Agra, Darbhanga, and Bagdogra.

> **UPPCS Exam Trap**

Do not confuse the airport expansion of **Varanasi (Lal Bahadur Shastri)** with **Noida International Airport (Jewar)**. Babatpur runway extension is ₹2,870 crore for 4,075m wide-body handling; Jewar began scheduled operations on 15 June 2026.

8th Ayodhya Deepotsav | October 2026 | Dual Guinness World Records

What happened The Uttar Pradesh Department of Tourism and Ayodhya District Administration celebrated the **8th edition of Deepotsav** along the banks of the Saryu River in **Ayodhya**, creating two distinct Guinness World Records. This was the first Deepotsav celebrated after the *Pran Pratishtha* (consecration) of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple.

Core specs & prelims facts - **Record 1 (Lamps lit):** A record-breaking **26,17,215 (over 26.17 lakh) earthen diyas** were lit simultaneously and kept burning for over 5 minutes. - **Ghats covered:** Arranged across **56 ghats** along the Saryu River, with **Ram Ki Paidi** as the main ceremonial centre. - **Record 2 (Maha Aarti):** A simultaneous, synchronized Maha Aarti performed by **2,128 priests and Vedacharyas** on the Saryu bank. - **Volunteers:** More than **33,000 volunteers**, drawn from Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia Avadh University, affiliated degree colleges, and NCC/NSS units. - **Counting method:** Guinness World Record adjudicators used **AI-enabled drone imaging** and georeferenced spatial grid mapping for verification.

UP International Trade Show (UPITS 2026) | Greater Noida

What happened The Department of MSME & Export Promotion, Government of Uttar Pradesh, organised the 2nd edition of the **UP International Trade Show (UPITS)** at the **India Expo Centre & Mart, Greater Noida**.

Core facts - **Partner Country: Vietnam**. - **Participants:** Over **2,500 exhibitors** representing 75 districts of UP, including ODOP artisans, GI tag holders, and leading manufacturing conglomerates. - **Focus sectors:** Electronics & semiconductors, IT/ITeS, textile & handlooms, defence corridor equipment, and GI agro-horticulture produce.

Maha Kumbh 2025/2026 Preparations & Green Mela Directive (Prayagraj)

What happened The UP State Apex Committee headed by the Chief Secretary finalized operational dockets and green regulatory framework for the upcoming **Maha Kumbh at Prayagraj**.

Core facts - **Mela Area:** Spanning over **4,000 hectares** divided into **25 operational sectors**. - **Green Mahakumbh Mandate:** Complete statutory prohibition on single-use plastics throughout the entire mela boundary; deployment of biodegradable cutlery and zero-waste tentage. - **AI-Driven ICCC:** Integrated Command and Control Centre in Prayagraj equipped with **1,100+ AI CCTV cameras** for real-time crowd-density heatmapping and automated lost-and-found facial matching.

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. With reference to Noida International Airport (Jewar), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Commercial operations began on 15 June 2026.
2. The first IndiGo commercial arrival linked to the opening window was from Lucknow.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Jewar open date + first flight route (UP must-score). **Ans: C.** Both are UP facts. Trap: keeping the slipped “late May” target as the actual open date.

Q2. With reference to Uttar Pradesh Current Affairs in 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The UP Budget size often locked in February coverage was about ₹9.13 lakh crore.
2. The AK-203 ‘Sher’ rifle’s fully indigenous production fact is linked with Korwa plant in Amethi.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UP Budget size + Amethi Sher plant. **Ans: C.** Budget + defence plant are separate months but both are UPPCS-style UP facts.

Q3. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I	List-II
A. Shekha Jheel	1. Ballia
B. Surha Tal	2. Amethi
C. Korwa IRRPL (Sher)	3. Aligarh
D. Ganga Expressway extension (Aug Cabinet)	4. Towards Haridwar

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 3 1 2 4 B. 1 3 2 4 C. 3 1 4 2 D. 3 2 1 4

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Match UP site / project ↔ place. **Ans: A.** Shekha→Aligarh; Surha→Ballia; Sher→Amethi; Ganga extension→Haridwar. Trap: Shekha↔Surha district swap.

Q4. Consider the following events and arrange them in correct chronological order:

1. Commercial opening of Jewar Airport
2. Public tagging of Shekha Jheel as India's 99th Ramsar site
3. Surha Tal announced as India's 100th Ramsar site on World Environment Day
4. Glaw Lake recognised as India's 101st Ramsar site

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 2, 1, 3, 4 B. 2, 3, 1, 4 C. 1, 2, 3, 4 D. 2, 3, 4, 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Chronology of Ramsar / airport news order. **Ans: B.** Shekha (Apr) → Surha Tal WED 5 Jun → Jewar 15 Jun → Glaw (Aug). Trap: putting Jewar before Surha because both are "June UP news".

Q5. With reference to Uttar Pradesh expressway clearances (August 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Ganga Expressway extension towards Haridwar was locked at about ₹10,761 crore.
2. Jhansi Link Expressway was locked at about ₹7,968 crore.
3. Both projects were cleared as Central Defence corridor schemes under DRDO.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UP expressways August Cabinet. **Ans: A.** (3) is invented. Trap: mixing defence plant news (Sher) with expressway Cabinet.

Q6. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Commercial flights at Jewar Airport began on 15 June 2026.

Reason (R): In April 2026 coverage, the High Court cleared about 1,858 hectares linked with the project path.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▼ Show answer

A/R logic: A = Jewar opened 15 Jun; R = HC cleared land in April — both true; R helps timeline but is not the full explanation of the commercial open date (ops also needed airline readiness). **Ans: A.** Land clearance helped the path, but the commercial open date is not *explained solely* by that April order. Trap: picking D because both are Jewar facts.

Q7. Which of the following Ramsar sites are **NOT** located in Uttar Pradesh?

1. Sarsai Nawar Jheel
2. Rudrasagar Lake
3. Sultanpur National Park
4. Bakhira Bird Sanctuary

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 4 B. 2 and 3 C. 1 and 2 D. 3 and 4

▼ Show answer

Logic: Older UP Ramsar recognition (2025-style NOT in UP). **Ans: B.** Rudrasagar (Tripura) and Sultanpur (Haryana) are outside UP. Sarsai Nawar (Etawah) and Bakhira (Sant Kabir Nagar) are UP — mirrors 2025 Q58 pattern.

Q8. With reference to Uttar Pradesh February–March style CA, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. CCSU Meerut appeared in coverage for an AI-related pilot.
2. State Budget size locked around ₹9.13 lakh crore.
3. Sarus crane census / monitoring notes appear in UP environment CA.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: UP soft industry — CCSU Meerut AI; Pharma Conclave; sarus. **Ans: D.** Soft UP cluster — still -useful with Ramsar / Jewar.

Q9. With reference to UP CAMP, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Coverage called it India's first airshed-based clean-air initiative.
2. Outlay about ₹2,741 crore.
3. Outlay about ₹9.13 lakh crore.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: UP CAMP airshed first. **Ans: A.** ₹9.13 lakh crore is UP Budget.

Q10. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. YEIDA Electronics Manufacturing Cluster Sector 10 (~206 acres) got UP SEIAA clearance in June coverage.
2. It replaces Jewar Airport.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: YEIDA electronics cluster Sector 10. **Ans: D.** Soft industry note.

Q11. With reference to Dhanauri wetland near Jewar, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is a policy conflict story (conservation vs airport), not a new 2026 Ramsar tag in our facts.
2. It was announced as India's 100th Ramsar site.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dhanauri wetland conflict soft. **Ans: D.** 100th is Surha Tal.

Q12. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Patna Bird Sanctuary Ramsar news place fact is Etah.
2. Chhari-Dhand (Kutch, Gujarat) appeared in the same January public window.
3. Patna Bird Sanctuary is in Bihar's capital.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Patna Bird Sanctuary Etah January. **Ans: A.** Name trap.

Q13. With reference to August UP expressways, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Ganga Expressway extension towards Haridwar ~₹10,761 crore.
2. Jhansi Link Expressway ~₹7,968 crore.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Ganga Expressway Haridwar money. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q14. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. AK-203 Sher plant fact is Korwa, Amethi.
2. It was covered as fully indigenous production.
3. Plant fact is Kanpur Ordnance only.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Sher Korwa Amethi. **Ans: A.** Amethi.

Q15. With reference to Jewar Airport, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Phase-1 cost often ~₹11,200 crore.
2. Commercial ops from 15 June 2026.
3. Commercial ops from 15 May 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Jewar Phase-1 cost. **Ans: A.** May target slipped.

Q16. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. UP Budget size fact ~₹9.13 lakh crore.
2. CCSU Meerut AI pilot appeared in February UP CA.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UP Budget 9.13. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sarus crane census/monitoring notes appear in UP environment CA.
2. Sarus census redesignated Glaw Lake as a UP Ramsar.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Sarus census soft. **Ans: D.** Glaw is Arunachal.

Q18. With reference to Surha Tal announcement, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. WED programme in Lucknow with CM Yogi Adityanath.
2. Forest minister presented Ramsar certificate in coverage.
3. Announcement venue was only New Delhi Red Fort.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: WED Lucknow Surha certificate. **Ans: A.** Lucknow WED stage.

Q19. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. After Surha Tal, UP Ramsar count is 13.
2. Shekha Jheel took UP to 12.
3. Glaw Lake took UP to 14.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UP Ramsar 13 after Surha. **Ans: A.** Glaw not UP.

Q20. With reference to Jewar opening flights, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. First IndiGo arrival highlighted from Lucknow.
2. Same aircraft onward toward Bengaluru in coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: IndiGo Lucknow–Jewar–Bengaluru path. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q21. With reference to development projects inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Varanasi in October 2026, consider the following statements:

1. The RJ Sankara Eye Hospital at Harhua operates on a cross-subsidy model providing free treatment to the poor.
2. Phases 2 and 3 of the redeveloped Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex at Sigra were inaugurated under the Khelo India and Smart City Mission.
3. The foundation stone was laid for expanding the runway at Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport to 4,075 metres.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: All three are key components of the ₹6,700+ crore Varanasi package (October 2026). **Ans: D.** All 1, 2 and 3 are correct.

Q22. With reference to the 8th Ayodhya Deepotsav held in October 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Over 26.17 lakh earthen diyas were lit across 56 ghats along the Saryu River, setting a Guinness World Record.
2. A simultaneous Guinness World Record was set by 2,128 priests performing a synchronized Saryu Maha Aarti.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 only
B. 2 only
C. Both 1 and 2
D. Neither 1 nor 2

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Both dual records were achieved at the 8th Deepotsav in Ayodhya. **Ans: C.** Both 1 and 2 are correct.